

Philipp Stark

Doctor Rer. Nat. Computer Science

Postdoctoral Fellow - Department of Human Geography, Lund University
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Academic Positions

Lund University, Sweden

Postdoctoral Fellow

Since Sep '24

Department of Human Geography. Focus: (Causal) Machine Learning, Representation Learning, Computational Social Science and Statistics

Leading the Hågerstrand Lab

Since March '26

Responsible for the development, coordination, and ongoing management of this computational lab within the Department, including personnel, resources, and research infrastructure. My role includes providing consultancy for computationally intensive projects, offering guidance on high-performance computing (HPC) solutions, and ensuring effective team structure and operations (<https://hagerstrandlab.se/>).

University of Tübingen, Germany

Researcher

Nov '20 - Jun '24

Researcher during doctoral studies at the Hector Research Institute of Education Sciences and Psychology.

Research Project Coordination & Technical Lead

Coordinated multi-study VR research projects, overseeing experimental planning, scheduling, and execution, while leading the full technical setup, maintenance, and in-situ support of VR hardware, software, and data pipelines during experimental sessions <http://vre-tuebingen.de/>.

Education

University of Tübingen, Germany

Dr. rer. nat. (Computer Science)

July '24

Towards Effective Virtual Reality Learning Environments: Assessment of Information Processing and Learning through Eye Tracking
<http://dx.doi.org/10.15496/publikation-96637>

M.Sc. Cognitive Science

Oct '20

B.Sc. Mathematics

Dec '18

B.A. Media Science & Political Science

March '16

Publications

2026

- Stark, P.**, Sopasakis, A., Hall, O., & Grillitsch, M. (2026). Using text-based life trajectories from swedish register data to predict residential mobility with pretrained transformers. *Advances in Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining, Lecture Notes in Artificial Intelligence (LNAI)*, 16600. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-92-1468-6_34
- Lau, K. H. C., **Stark, P.**, Bozkir, E., & Kasneci, E. (2026). Skin-deep bias: How avatar appearances shape perceptions of AI hiring. *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, Chi '26*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790379>
- Daltoè, T., Appel, T., **Stark, P.**, Brucker, B., Dreher, A., Fauth, B., Friesen, M., Gerjets, P., Hansen, L., Trautwein, U., & Göllner, R. (2026). How is preservice teachers' gaze during classroom observation connected to their assessments of teaching quality? A controlled study in screen-based and immersive video environments. *Learning and Instruction*, 101, Article 102260. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.learninstruc.2025.102260>
- Bueno, I., Bühler, B., **Stark, P.**, Fütterer, T., Trautwein, U., Demszky, D., Hill, H., & Kasneci, E. *From scoring to explanations: Evaluating SHAP and LLM rationales for rubric-based teaching quality assessment* (accepted at ACL 2026).

2025

- Göllner, R., Lazarides, R., & **Stark, P.** (2025). Revealing teaching quality through lesson semantics: A GPT -assisted analysis of transcripts. *British Journal of Educational Psychology*, bjep.70001. <https://doi.org/10.1111/bjep.70001>
- Lau, K. H. C., Sen, S., **Stark, P.**, Bozkir, E., & Kasneci, E. (2025). Adaptive Gen-AI Guidance in Virtual Reality: A Multimodal Exploration of Engagement in Neapolitan Pizza-Making. *ICMI 2025*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/ARXIV.2411.18438>

2024

- Stark, P.**, Jung, A. J., Hahn, J.-U., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2024). Using Gaze Transition Entropy to Detect Classroom Discourse in a Virtual Reality Classroom. *Proceedings of the 2024 Symposium on Eye Tracking Research and Applications*, 1–11. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3649902.3653335>
- Stark, P.**, Bozkir, E., Sójka, W., Huff, M., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2024). The impact of presentation modes on mental rotation processing: A comparative analysis of eye movements and performance. *Scientific Reports*, 14(1), 12329. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-024-60370-6>
- Stark, P.**, Hasenbein, L., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2024). Gaze-based attention network analysis in a virtual reality classroom. *MethodsX*, 12, 102662. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.mex.2024.102662>
- Ferdinand, J., Gao, H., **Stark, P.**, Bozkir, E., Hahn, J.-U., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2024). The impact of a usefulness intervention on students' learning achievement in a virtual biology lesson: An eye-tracking-based approach. *Learning and Instruction*, 90, 101867. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.learninstruc.2023.101867>
- Stark, P.** (2024). Towards Effective Virtual Reality Learning Environments: Assessment of Information Processing and Learning through Eye Tracking <http://dx.doi.org/10.15496/publikation-96637>

2023

- Gao, H., Bozkir, E., **Stark, P.**, Goldberg, P., Meixner, G., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2023). Detecting Teacher Expertise in an Immersive VR Classroom: Leveraging Fused Sensor

Data with Explainable Machine Learning Models. *2023 IEEE International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality (ISMAR)*, 683–692.
<https://doi.org/10.1109/ISMAR59233.2023.00083>

Hasenbein, L., **Stark, P.**, Trautwein, U., Gao, H., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2023). Investigating social comparison behaviour in an immersive virtual reality classroom based on eye-movement data. *Scientific Reports*, 13, 14672.
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-41704-2>

Stark, P., Appel, T., Olbrich, M., & Kasneci, E. (2023) Pupil Diameter during Counting Tasks as Potential Baseline for Virtual Reality Experiments. *In Proceedings of the 2023 Symposium on Eye Tracking Research and Applications (ETRA '23)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, USA, 17, 1–7.
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3588015.3588414>

2021-22

Hasenbein, L., **Stark, P.**, Trautwein, U., Queiroz, A. C. M., Bailenson, J., Hahn, J.-U., & Göllner, R. (2022). Learning with simulated virtual classmates: Effects of social-related configurations on students' visual attention and learning experiences in an immersive virtual reality classroom. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 133, 107282.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2022.107282>

Bozkir*, E., **Stark*, P.**, Gao, H., Hasenbein, L., Hahn, J.-U., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. (2021). Exploiting Object-of-Interest Information to Understand Attention in VR Classrooms. *2021 IEEE Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces*, 597–605.
<https://doi.org/10.1109/VR50410.2021.00085> (*both authors contributed equally)

In Preparation

Stark, P., van Borris, A., Grillitsch, M., Hall, O., & Sopasakis, A., Empirical Evaluation of Temporal Harmonization of Industry Classifications with Swedish Microdata (*in preparation for submission to the Journal of Official Statistics*)

Stark P., & Grillitsch, M, AI in Social Sciences Research: Theoretical and Methodological Implication (*Extended abstract submitted to the Journal of Economic Geography special issue "Advancing Economic GeoAI"*)

Stark, P., Sopasakis, A., Hall, O., & Grillitsch, M., Learning Latent Industry Representations for Regional Opportunity Spaces and Path Development (in preparation for submission to PNAS, extended abstract submitted to CS2Nordics)

Stark, P., Hall, O., Ekström, E. C., Jirström, Vision-Language Models for Food Environment Monitoring in Underrepresented Markets: A Pilot Study from Ethiopia (short paper conference submission)

Projects

Stark, P., Hall, O., Sopasakis, A., & Grillitsch, M., *NEXUS – Machine Learning on Swedish Register Data*

Stark, P., Hall, O., Ekström, E. C., Jirström, M. *AI-Powered Store Insights: Analyzing Advertising in Ethiopian Souk Shops using Vision Language Models*

Friedrich, J., **Stark, P.**, Cardona, M. & Stihl, L., *Evaluating Adaptation and Policy Failure in EU Textile Waste Governance Using AI-Supported Newspaper Analysis*

Yuan, L., **Stark, P.** & Grillitsch, M. *Detect Inter-Firm Knowledge Connectivity Combining Mobile Phone and Register Data*

Melgaco, L., Coelho, L. X. P., Schreiber, F., & **Stark, P.** *Racial Spatial Inequality and Urban Transformation in Brazil: A Three-Decade Grid-Based Census Analysis of Racial Concentration, Mega-Projects, and Socioeconomic Change*

Stark, P., & Yuan, L., *Causal Machine Learning and Latent Representations in Social Science*

Stark, P., Erlström, A., Grillitsch, M., Hall, O., & Sopasakis, A., *Temporal Harmonization of Industry Classifications with Swedish Register Data*
<https://portal.research.lu.se/en/projects/temporal-harmonization-of-industry-classifications-with-swedish-r>

Funding and Grants

Awarded

Co-Principal Investigator (Co-PI)

Friedrich, J., Jessen, S., Stark, P. (2026)

Leveraging Large-Scale Newspaper Data to Uncover Regional Negotiations of the Green Transition in the EU,

Crafoord Foundation, Nr 20260836 – SEK 600 000 (~55 000€)

Principal Investigator (PI)

Stark, P., Erlström, A., Grillitsch, M., Hall, O., Sopasakis, A. (2025)

Temporal Harmonization of Industry Classifications with Swedish Register Data

AI Lund Initiative, Lund University — SEK 62,391 (~5800€)

Project portal: <https://portal.research.lu.se/en/projects/temporal-harmonization-of-industry-classifications-with-swedish-r>

Applications and Participation (Ongoing / Submitted)

Co-Applicant

Hall, O., Stark, P., Toger, M., & Sopasakis, A.

Calibrated Earth Observation for Climate–Health Attribution: Quantifying Temperature–Mortality and Temperature–Morbidity Relationships in Sweden, 1990–2020

Swedish National Space Agency — Utlysning 2026-R

Participating Researcher

Östh, J., Dahlberg, M., Stark, P., Hall, O.

Migration and Resilience in a Changing World: A Global Spatial Analysis Using Demographic and Remote Sensing Data

Project Partner

HORIZON-CL2-2026-01-TRANSFO-02: Open topic: Strengthening Europe's social model and sustainable competitiveness through productivity

Consortium including Lund University, University of Bologna, Austrian Institute of Technology, Nicolaus Copernicus University, University of Pécs, Charles University

Rejected

Principal Investigator (PI)

Stark, P., Martynovich, M.,

Social Data Analysis in a Data-Saturated World

X-course Initiative, Education Committee, Lund University (Development of interdisciplinary course proposal)

Co-Principal Investigator (Co-PI)

Mattsson, P., Stark, P., Hall, O., Grillitsch, M.

Life Trajectories and Rural Renewal: Explaining Entrepreneurial Pathways of Urban-to-Rural

Movers

Kamprad Family Foundation for Entrepreneurship, Research & Charity

Project Partner

HORIZON-CL2-2025-01-DEMOCRACY-04

Consortium including: Joanneum Research; Deutsches Zentrum für Luft- und Raumfahrt (DLR); Fondation pour la Recherche Stratégique; Școala Națională de Studii Politice și Administrative; University of Warsaw

Project Partner

HORIZON-CL2-2025-01-TRANSFO-02

Consortium including: University of Bologna, Lund University, Austrian Institute of Technology, Nicolaus Copernicus University, University of Pécs, Charles University

Presentations

**presenting author*

Organized Workshops

Stark, P.* & Forsyth, R.*, Workshop on *Generative AI Tools in University Education*, 2025, Lund University

Recent Invited Talks

Stark, P., Learning from Registers - *GeoAI and Mechanism of Machine Learning* in the Context of Large-Scale Register Data. Nobel-X 2025 // PhD X 2025. Oslo Metropolitan University.

Stark, P., Machine Learning for Modeling Dynamics in the Swedish Labor Market, 2025 Mixed Methods Research Conference, Halmstad University

Stark, P., Eye Tracking in Education Research, Guest Lecturer: 2023 Block Course on Eye Tracking, Chair for Human-Centered Technologies for Learning, Technical University of Munich, Germany

Recent Talks

Stark, P. *Text-Based Life Trajectories from Swedish Register Data: Predicting Residential Mobility with Pretrained Transformers*. Presentation at the Pacific-Asia Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (PAKDD 2026), Hong Kong.

Stark, P., & Göllner, R. *Linking Teachers' Self-Efficacy with Effective Learning: Testing the Mediation Path Through Classroom Semantics*. Symposium contribution at the 13th Congress of the Society for Empirical Educational Research (GEBF 2026), Potsdam, Germany.

Bueno, I., Bühler, B., **Stark, P.**, Fütterer, T., Trautwein, U., Demszky, D., Hill, H., & Kasneci, E. *From Scoring to Teacher Feedback: NLP-based Teaching Quality Score Interpretability with SHAP Values*. Symposium contribution at the 13th Congress of the Society for Empirical Educational Research (GEBF 2026), Potsdam, Germany.

Stark, P.*, Predicting Household and Workplace Mobility in Sweden from Individual Life Trajectories with Transformers, 2025 CIRCLE Research Symposium, Lund University (upcoming)

Stark, P.* Machine Learning for Modeling Dynamics in the Swedish Labor Market – Opportunities and Challenges, 2025, Centre for Innovation Research CIRCLE, Lund University

Göllner, R.*, **Stark, P.**, Hasenbein, L., Stürmer, K., Goldberg, P., Recognizing Student Disruptions in a VR Classroom: An Expertise Comparison Using Behavioral Process Data. 2023 Working Group for Empirical Pedagogical Research (AEPF), Potsdam, Germany

Stark, P.*, Gao, H., Goldberg, P., Bozkir, E., Kasneci, E., Göllner, R., Machine Learning for Analyzing Professional Vision in the Virtual Classroom. Symposium on Classroom Experience in Virtual Reality as an Opportunity for Teacher Education. 2023 GEPE conference (Society for Empirical Educational Research), Essen, Germany

Stark, P.*, Hasenbein, L., Bozkir, E., Gao, H., Kasneci, E., The Use of Eye Tracking in Virtual Reality in Educational Research. Symposium on Virtual Realities in Empirical Teaching-Learning Research. 2022 GEPE conference (Society for Empirical Educational Research), Bamberg, Germany

Goldberg, P.*, Göllner, R., Hasenbein, L., **Stark, P.**, Stürmer, K. Recognizing Classroom Disruptions as Relevant: An Expertise Comparison in the Virtual Classroom. Symposium on Keeping an eye on the classroom: New insights into situation-specific skills of inexperienced teachers in the context of effective classroom management. 2022 GEPE conference (Society for Empirical Educational Research), Bamberg, Germany

Bozkir, E., **Stark, P.***, Gao, H., Hasenbein, L., Hahn, J.-U., Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R. Exploiting Object-of-Interest Information to Understand Attention in VR Classrooms. 2021 IEEE Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces Conference, Virtual

Posters

Stark, P., Bozkir, E., Huff, M., Sójka W.*, Kasneci, E., & Göllner, R., The Impact of Presentation Modes on Mental Rotation Processing. NeNa 2023 (Neuroscience Young Investigators Conference), Frankfurt, Germany

Stark, P.*, Appel, T., Olbrich, M., Kasneci, E. Pupil Diameter during Counting Tasks as Potential Baseline for Virtual Reality Experiments. 2023 ACM Symposium of Eye Tracking Research & Applications (ETRA)

Teaching Experience

I have accumulated 723.5 registered (~850 by now) teaching hours in total. My teaching spans quantitative methods, statistics, computer-based data analysis, and research methodology.

- **2026 Course development (assigned)** activity for the 30 ECTS course in Spatial Data Science within the free-standing modules of the bachelor's program in Human Geography.

- **2026** – *Research Design and Methods in Development Studies (Master of Science Programme in International Development and Management (LUMID)), Introduction to Quantitative Research (SGEA23, Human Geography, 30 ECTS; UTVC24, Development Studies, 15 ECTS), Bachelor Thesis Preparation Course (SGEK03 Research Methods).*

- **2025** – *Bachelor Thesis Preparation Course (SGEK03 Research Methods) [47h]. Introduction to Quantitative Approaches (SGEA23, Human Geography, 30 ECTS; UTVC24, Development Studies, 15 ECTS) [99h].*

- **2023*** – *Seminar: Quantitative Data Analysis (Evaluation: 1.8).*

- **2022*** – *Seminar: Computer-based Data Analysis (Evaluation: 1.3). Seminar: Quantitative Data Analysis (Evaluation: 1.1).*

- **2021*** – *Seminar: Computer-based Data Analysis (Evaluation: 1.6). Seminar: Quantitative Data Analysis (Evaluation: 1.4).*

In addition, I have supervised bachelor's theses in both education science and computer science, combining methodological guidance with academic writing support. Furthermore, I am engaging in non-official PhD supervision in different projects.

**Responsible for the complete seminar (see attachment for hours). German universities grading scheme: 1.0 - 1.5 (very good); 1.51 - 2.5 (good); 2.51 - 3.5 (satisfactory); 3.51 - 4.0 (sufficient); >4 (not sufficient)*

Pedagogical Training

- 2026 **[starting] Course Development in Higher Education** at the Division for Higher Education Development, Lund University (2 weeks)
- 2025 **Teaching and Learning in Higher Education** at the Division for Higher Education Development, Lund University (2 weeks)
- 2025 **Teaching and Learning Research Methods in Social Sciences** at the Social Science Faculty, Lund University (2 weeks) (to be completed)
- 2019 Mathematik Lehren Lernen (**Learn to teach mathematics**, 2 ETCS)

Mentoring

- 2022 Bennet Blum, **Bachelor thesis in computer science**, University of Tübingen
- 2022 Katja Schnitzer, **Bachelor thesis in education science**, University of Tübingen
- 2021-2022 [Weronika Sójka](#) was student assistant in my VR project, is now a PhD candidate with the International Max Planck Research School (IMPRS) in Tübingen. I supervised her work on the project.

Reviewing

- 2026 *CVPR 2026 Workshop GAZE, Member of ICMI 2026 Program Committee, ISMAR26*
- 2026 *Acta Psychologica, Learning and Motivation*
- 2025 *Acta Psychologica, PLOS Computational Biology, Journal of Human-Computer Interaction, Cerebral Cortex*
- 2025 *Computer Science Conferences: ISMAR 2025 (2 papers), ETRA 2025 (2 short papers), ETRA 2025 GenEAI*
- 2024 *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*
- 2024 *Computer Science Conferences: ETRA 2024 ETVIS, AMCIS 2024 Papers, ISMAR 2024 Journal Papers*

Professional Development

Service and Outreach

- 2026 **Co-Organizer**, EU-SPRI Autumn School (Early Career Research Training) *Responsible AI for Science, Technology, Innovation, and Policy* CIRCLE, Lund University, Lund, Sweden (Autumn 2026)
- 2025 **Interview Committee Member** - Assistant Professor in Human Geography with a Focus on (Geo)AI, Regional Development, and Spatial Planning *Department of Human Geography, Lund University*

2024	Workshop on Writing a Grand Proposal
2024	Workshop on Negotiation Skills and Moderation
2023-2024	Student volunteer chair , 2024 Eye Tracking Research and Applications (ETRA) conference in Glasgow, England
2023	Cooperation for science communication in practice , Seminar for Training and Further Education of Teachers Stuttgart (for vocational schools), Stuttgart, Germany
2022-2023	Student volunteer chair and technical support , 2023 Eye Tracking Research and Applications (ETRA) conference in Tübingen, Germany
2021-2022	PhD representative , LEAD Graduate School and Research Network
2016-2017	Erasmus at the University of Manchester in Mathematics
2016	BA thesis presentation , Summer School Risky Understanding at the University of North Carolina
Since 2019	Election worker , Regional and national elections of the Federal Republic of Germany

Professional Experience

2019-2020	Academic Tutor , Mathematics in Computer Science, Department of Computer Science, University of Tübingen
2017-2019	Research Assistant , Knowledge Construction Department, Leibniz-Institut für Wissensmedien, Tübingen
2014-2015	Research Assistant , Empirical Media Research Department, Institute of Media Studies, University of Tübingen
2014-2015	Academic Tutor , Introduction to Media Science, Institute of Media Studies, University of Tübingen

Membership & Affiliations

Affiliated with the **Swedish Competence Centre for Satellite Enabled Social Science Analytics** <https://sesac.se>

Affiliated with **AI Lund** - An open network for research, education and innovation in the area of Artificial Intelligence at Lund University <https://www.ai.lu.se/philipp-stark> (Sweden)

Associated Member of the **Centre for Innovation Research CIRCLE**, Lund University (Sweden)

Affiliated with the **Social Science Methods Center – Division: Computational Social Science** <https://www.sam.lu.se/en/research/lund-social-science-methods-centre/computational-social-science> (Sweden)

Affiliated with **Climate AI Nordics** <https://climateainordics.com/> (RISE Research Institutes of Sweden AB, Sweden)

PhD Candidate in the **LEAD Graduate School and Research Network**. <https://uni-tuebingen.de/en/research/core-research/lead-graduate-school-research-network/>

Associate Member of the **Society for Empirical Educational Research** (GEPE, Germany)